

Paper 4, Option 4F: Sikhism

Topics	What students need to learn	
1 Religious beliefs, values and teachings	1.1	Sikhs and the divine (1) a) Sikh teachings about the nature and existence of God; how Sikhs envisage the divine and the way to unite with it. This will include: - o reference to key concepts about Waheguru: oneness, sat, shabad, especially the Mool Mantar, nam, hukam, nadar - o reference to key concepts about the nature of the self, the meaning and purpose of life, death and the afterlife, including maya, guru, nadar, gurmukh, manmukh, mukti, samsara and karma. b) Contrasting the meaning of these ideas in contemporary Sikhism with pre-existing Indic thought, comparison of Sikh ideas with those of the sant movement, examining it as background for the emergence of Sikh thought tracing the impact of existing thought and practices on the beliefs, values and teachings of Guru Nanak. With reference to the ideas of K E Nayar and J S Sandhu.
	1.2	The importance of sangat a) The development of this concept in the lives of the Gurus, including building spiritual and political centres at Amritsar. b) Study of the concept of Panth as a qaum or nation and the authority and status of the Panth as Guru from the lifetime of Guru Gobind Singh. c) The meaning of sangat today looking at local and global levels and at virtual and physical communities. With reference to the ideas of N K Singh and K Nayar.
	1.3	Key moral principles and values a) Nam japna, kirt karna and vand chakna and their applications in gurmukh lifestyles today. b) The key principle of seva (service to God and to others). c) Miri-piri as the unique, original and distinctive feature of Sikhism, including a study of the warrior tradition. d) Sikh values as expressions of the quality of manmukh. With reference to the ideas of N K Singh and J Sandhu.